

The Groove Launchbar

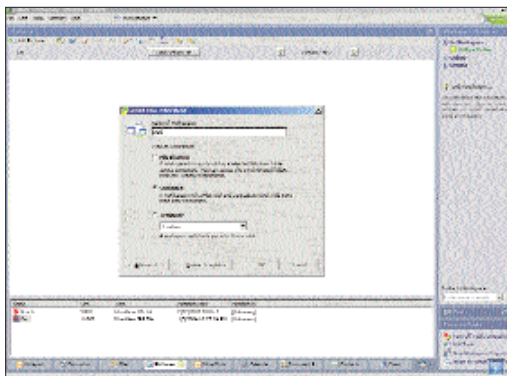
around 30 minutes on a decent Internet connection. But beyond that, it's not always necessary to be online to work.

Information that others edit in a file can be available to you offline as well—so long as you collect the latest update of a file. Hence the restrictions of having a slow or low-bandwidth connection are also negated.

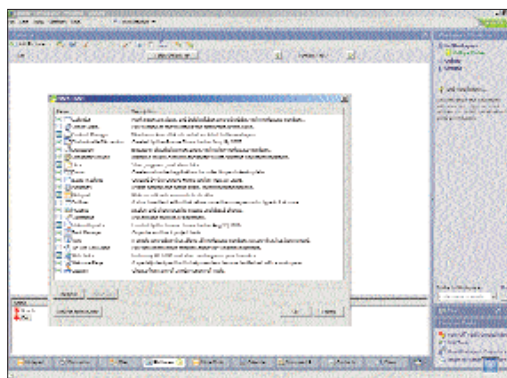
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How It Works

Creators of a workspace and members with all necessary permissions can invite other users to the workspace. This can be done using 'Contacts' (which can be imported from Outlook or Outlook Express) in the 'Launchbar' or from within the



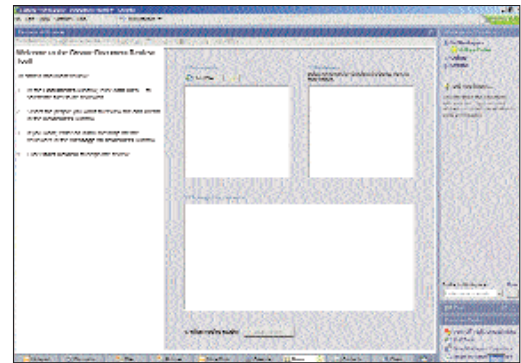
Creating a new workspace from scratch



Adding tools to your workspace. This would determine what tools are usable by all members

What Groove Offers

- ☑ You can see which members of your team are online
- ☑ You can conduct a conversation, post questions and get answers about files, projects or processes
- ☑ You can plan, conduct, and follow up on real-time online meetings. Let team members update their own action items and project tasks
- ☑ The Project Edition includes advanced features such as Gantt charts, milestone tracking, defining predecessor tasks, and integration with Microsoft Project.



The filesharing app. Using this simple window, multiple users can share and work on a common file

workspace itself. Those not already using Groove can also be invited via e-mail.

Set by default, the workspace creator is the 'Manager', and can set the roles and permissions of others in the workspace as a whole, or within specific workspace tools.

One of the most significant features is the contextual presence awareness within workspaces. A user can quickly see which other members of the workspace are currently online, whether they are working in that workspace, and even the 'tool' they are using. This allows good use of 'presence awareness' (as against the limited information afforded by Instant Messaging), which lets people determine whether to interrupt someone else based on their current work status.

If someone is in a workspace and in the 'Files' tool, that worker is also open to a chat or phone call. However, if he is not (because he may be heading off to another project in another workspace), you could send a message, which causes less interruption.

Once the workspace is established—from scratch or via a template—team members with the required permissions can add and delete tools and tool content as required, a frequent occurrence as the workspace evolves.

From within the 'Files' tool, a user can select another online user and initiate a co-review of a presentation or document. Normally, such functions are found only in advanced online meeting products. But with the Groove, you can combine real-time and persistent collaboration.

Some of the other impressive tools include a Text editor, discussion areas where earlier discussions are saved by default and include the topics and responses of individual members too.

But this is not merely a workspace where online collaboration is possible. A Forms tool allows the manager of the workspace to create custom forms that can be filled out by other users of the workspace.

Scheduling online meeting with other members is also a breeze with Groove. Just fill in the time and date and members of the meeting.

You can choose how you want to view all details and also assign tasks for the meeting like the minute-taker and the chairperson for the meeting. Very useful.

There you have it... your entire team finally on the same page! ☑

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